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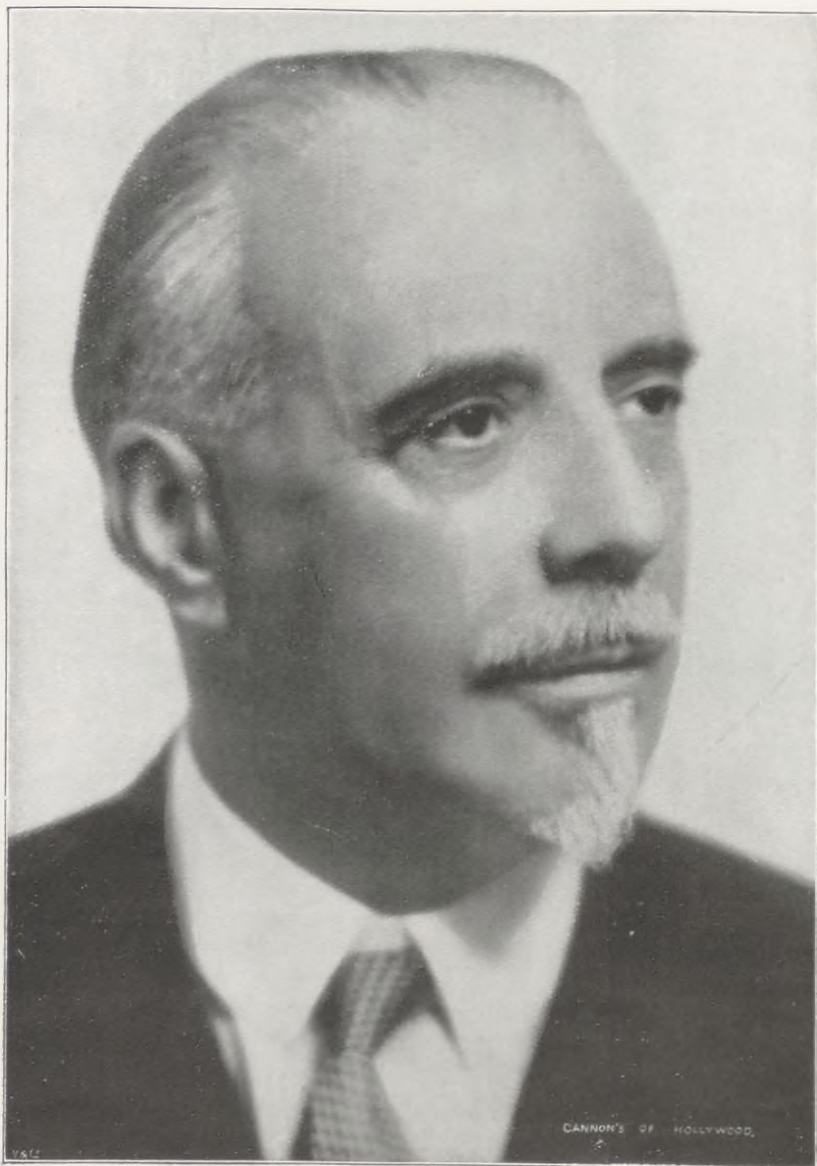
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SOLOIST :

RENÉ LE ROY

CONDUCTOR :

Sir Thomas Beecham
BART.



SIR THOMAS BEECHAM, Bcrt.

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Smoking is Prohibited in the Auditorium

PROGRAMME

(Analytical Notes by Edwin Evans)

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LONDON PHILHARMONIC ORCHESTRA
Conductor - SIR THOMAS BEECHAM, Bart.

1.

Symphony No. 1 in C Major *Beethoven*
(1770-1827)

Adagio molto—Allegro con brio.

Andante cantabile con molto.

Minuetto e Trio.

Adagio—Allegro molto e vivace.

It was in the spring of 1795, when Beethoven was studying counterpoint with Albrechtsberger, that he first planned to write a symphony. From the occurrence of sketches among fugal exercises Grove suggests that in the first place it may have been a relief from dry technical work. Originally it was to be in C minor, but presently that key was abandoned in favour of C major. It is not definitely known when it was completed, but probably not long before the first performance, which took place on April 2nd, 1800, at the Burg Theatre. It was Beethoven's first benefit concert, and, in addition to works by Haydn and Mozart, the programme included the Septet and one of the two first Piano Concertos—it is not certain which. The composer also improvised on the theme of Haydn's *Emperor's Hymn*. Beethoven was thirty at the time. At that age Mozart had written all but the last three of his symphonies, and Schubert seven works in this form, but Brahms was forty-four before he wrote his first symphony.

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It was Beethoven's first work for the orchestra alone. His only previous orchestral writing consisted of one movement of a discarded violin concerto, and the two first Pianoforte Concertos. The work is scored for the usual orchestra, as employed by Mozart. It is dedicated to Baron von Swieten, who had befriended the composer on his first arrival in Vienna. Because of its close affinity with the works of Mozart and Haydn it has been called "the instrumental swan-song of the eighteenth century," but in spite of that the circumstance that it opens out of the key, and with a discord, gravely incensed several critics of the time, notably the Abbé Stadler.

That discord opens a brief introduction, an *Adagio* lasting twelve bars. The first subject of the *Allegro* is characteristic of Beethoven's fondness for emphasising the key. The second subject present itself as a dialogue for flute and oboe over a figure in crotchets which can be regarded as derived from the first. This leads to a brief episode in which the oboe—followed by bassoon—has a counter-subject while the basses quietly continue figures derived from the second subject. Nine bars of coda complete the exposition. The working-out is simple and constructed of alternating fragments from the two subjects, with rather more use of imitation than Beethoven employed in later years. The recapitulation differs in orchestration from the opening, but is otherwise normal. The coda is based upon that which concluded the exposition, but here it is combined with the first subject. About half of the coda is devoted to emphasising the key.

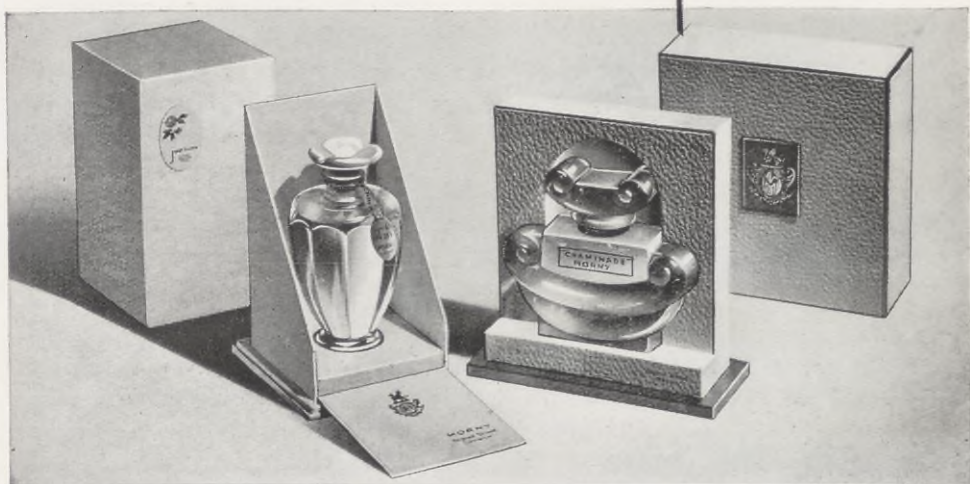
The *Andante* is built round a lyrical theme and its continuation, with a brief middle section derived from them. A remarkable feature is the use of the drums, which foreshadows much that Beethoven was to write later, notably the well-known passage in the Fifth Symphony. This charming movement, with its Mozartian elegance, is universally liked, but some of Beethoven's contemporaries were inclined to belittle it.

The Minuet has all the character of a true Beethoven Scherzo, from its brisk animation to the suggestion of deeper intent underlying the dance-rhythm. In the second portion of the Minuet there is also a bold modulatory passage, equally characteristic. The Trio consists of a kind of antiphon between wind-chords and string-scales.

The Finale, which is preceded by six bars of *Adagio*, has the merriment of Haydn together with a touch of the more refined playfulness of Mozart, especially that which occasionally shows itself in rapid conversation among several instruments. Its humour is unlike that which was later to be characteristic of Beethoven. It is not a Rondo, as one might have expected after the preceding movements, but in the form of a sonata-allegro, with the usual two subjects—both of great simplicity, and a short development section followed by recapitulation and coda.

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2.

Concerto in D major for Flute and Orchestra (K314) ...

Mozart

RENÉ LE ROY

(1756-1791)

*Allegro.**Allegro ma non troppo.**Rondo : Allegro.*

During the time which Mozart spent at Mannheim, from October 30th, 1777, to March 14th, 1778, he naturally became friendly with the soloists of what was then considered to be probably the finest orchestra in Europe. One of them was the celebrated flautist, Johann Baptist Wendling (1730-1797), one of the four players for whom he was to compose, during their subsequent visit to Paris, the Sinfonia Concertante for flute, oboe, horn and bassoon. When Mozart failed to find employment with the Elector and it looked as if he might have to curtail his stay in Mannheim, he told Wendling who, according to Jahn, grew red in the face and said "we must find some way of keeping you here, at all events for the two months before we go to Paris together." When Mozart dined with him next day they discussed ways and means. One contributor to these was a Dutchman, De Jean or Dechamps, of independent means, who played the flute and may have been a pupil of Wendling. He offered to pay 200 florins for three concertos and two quartets for the flute. He was nicknamed the Nabob, and in one of his letters Mozart refers to him as that true philanthropist, the Indian Dutchman. But Mozart procrastinated. When his father remonstrated with him by letter he replied, that "one is not always in the humor for writing. I could certainly scribble away the whole day; but when a thing is to go forth bearing my name, I am determined that I will not be ashamed of it." In the end the commission was only partly executed and he received only 96 florins in payment. Of the music that originated thus have survived two concertos and a separate Andante (K313-3) and two quartets for flute and strings (K285 and 928), one of which had to be sent from Paris after his departure.

The concerto opens with the usual *tutti* in which both the principal subjects are introduced in the main key. At its first entrance the flute comments on the principal theme and continues it with a passage modulating to the dominant for the second subject. The continuation of the first subject supplies most of the material of the working-outs section, which is brief. Recapitulation ensues. The whole movement is transparently clear, and, as Jahn says, lively and cheerful.

The orchestra gives out the first phrase of the slow movement, in G major. The solo flute repeats it and adds an after-phrase modulating temporarily to the dominant, but the digression is not extended, and on repetition the same passage serves to prepare the conclusion.

The principal theme of the Rondo is a very evident anticipation of Blonde's aria *Welche Wonne, welche Lust* in the *Seraglio*, which was composed four years later. It is begun on the solo instrument but soon taken over by the orchestra. The episodes consist chiefly of bravura passages for the flute, which is given little rest in this sprightly movement.

3.

Suite, "Pelléas and Mélisande" *Sibelius*

1865

- (i) *At the Castle-gate.*
- (ii) *Mélisande.*
- (iii) *A Spring in the Park.*
- (iv) *The Three Blind Sisters.*
- (v) *Pastorale.*
- (vi) *Mélisande at the Spinning Wheel.*
- (vii) *Entr'acte.*
- (viii) *The Death of Mélisande.*

Maeterlinck's play "Pelléas et Mélisande" is remarkable amongst other things for having inspired several famous composers. Even more remarkable is the astonishing diversity of utterance to which they have been inspired. It would be difficult, indeed, to find works more dissimilar than the vague atmospheric music of Debussy's opera, the delicate, clear-cut, neatly-chiselled incidental music of Fauré, and the gigantic and portentous symphonic poem of Schönberg.

Sibelius's music is again very different from all these, though nearer to Fauré's work, in spirit, than that of any of the others. Curiously enough, this music written to a play by a Flemish dramatist is more definitely Finnish in feeling than much that Sibelius has composed to national subjects. It can have been no mere caprice extraneous form of inducement that led him to incorporate the greater part of it, transcribed for the piano, in the volume of selected piano pieces entitled "Sibeliana"; Scenes from the land of a Thousand Lakes," in which, for example, the piece originally called "Mélisande" becomes "Evening by the Woodland Lake," and "The Death of Mélisande" becomes "The Sun Sinks." The latter titles, indeed, strike one as being even more in keeping with the character of the music from the original ones. However that may be, these little pieces rank amongst Sibelius's finest works in miniature forms. They are scored for a small orchestra consisting of flute, oboe, cor anglais, two clarinets, two bassoons, two horns, strings and percussion. The work was written in 1905.

The first number, "At the Castle-gate," is the prelude to the first scene of the first act of the drama—broad, sonorous, majestic, tragedy-laden, preoccupied throughout its brief course with one single theme.

"Mélisande" is played as the prelude to the second scene of the first act—a charming little piece, wonderfully evocative of the character in the play. It begins with the cor anglais solo to an accompaniment of muted violins and violas only. The 'cellos echo and vary it, the cor anglais solo to an accompaniment of muted violin and violas only. The 'cellos echo and vary it, the cor anglais takes it up again, but soon makes way for a new line of thought: a wistful little melody for strings replied to by another slightly gayer one for the wood-wind with a *pizzicato* accompaniment for the strings. This slended but engaging material is repeated and varied.

A gently, easy-flowing melody for strings to an accompaniment of wood-wind and held notes for the horns constitutes the chief thematic substance of number 3, "A Spring in the Park" (which is the prelude to the second act), for the first part of its course. This is succeeded by a short passage of delicate impressionism, then a sudden and unexpected *crescendo* culminating in a sonorous climax, after which the music dies away with fragmentary allusions to the initial thought.

"The Three Blind Sisters," a transcription of the song in Act III, Scene 2, consists of a short cor anglais solo, first over a roll for kettle-drums, then entirely unaccompanied, followed by a passage for clarinets supported by horns, then by strings *pizzicato*, then by horns and drums.

The "Pastorale" is the instrument interlude which follows the words "Quelle belle journée" in Act III, Scene 4. Its character is sufficiently indicated by its title, with wood-wind playing the principle role to an accompaniment of strings and horns. This is one of the simplest and most attractive pieces in the suite.

"Mélisande at the Spinning-wheel," which plays as the prelude to the third act, is, on the other hand, one of the most subtle and elaborate numbers, though none the less attractive. It is ingeniously constructed on an unending whirling figure for violas, descriptive of the spinning wheel, which plays unaltered from first bar to last, against which is projected expressive melodic fragments chiefly confided to the wood-wind. A climax is achieved, whereafter the music gradually subsides and dies away.

The "Entr'acte" is played between third and fourth acts. Its character is rather that of a distraction or diversion from the dramatic situation, unlike that of most of the foregoing numbers. It is a brisk, exhilarating and virile piece, employing the full resources of the modest orchestra for which it is scored.

Finally, in striking contrast to the foregoing number, both in character and in its relevance to the drama, is the deeply moving little piece descriptive of "The Death of Mélisande," which is the introduction to Act V, Scene 2. It begins with a passage for muted strings alone. After the wood-wind has intervened momentarily the strings resume their lament and the whole orchestra then participate in a passionate outburst of grief. The piece ends as it began, with muted strings alone.

Note by CECIL GRAY for the Sibelius Festival.

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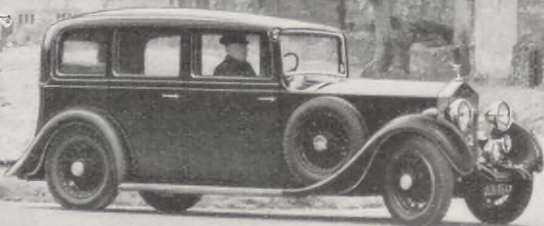
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Concerto in C for Flute

...
RENÉ LE ROY

Grétry

1741-1813

*Allegro**Larghetto**Allegro*

Grétry and César Franck are the two musical glories of the City of Liège, but they have little in common. Grétry was above all else a composer of popular and melodious operas of which he wrote forty-seven, first for the Opéra Comique and later for the opéra, and of these more than half was successful. His most famous productions are "Le Tableau parlant" (1769), "Zémire et Azore" (1771), "Céphale et Procris" (1773), and "Richard Cœur de Lion" (1784). His other vocal works include an early Mass and some cantatas written for national occasions under the Revolution. His instrumental works are comparatively few in number. They include an early set of six symphonies; two quartets for harpsichord, flute, violin and bass; and some trios and sonatas. From early days he appears to have given attention to the flute. He spent eight years in Rome—1759-1767, and it was a flute concerto—this or another—which provided the occasion and the means for his long desired migration to Paris. There was at that time an English peer who played the flute and was prepared to pay liberally for compositions for that instrument. Grétry's concerto came under his notice and pleased him so well that the outcome was the composer's journey, first to Geneva and then to Paris where he made his name and fortune.

5.

Menuet des Follets

Danse des Sylphes

Marche Hongroise

... }
 ... } From "The Damanation of Faust") *Berlioz*
 ... } 1803-1869

*Danse des Follets.**Danse des Sylphes.**Marche Hongroise.*

In 1828 Berlioz came under the spell of Goethe's *Faust* in Gérard de Nerval's French translation. He records in his Memoirs: "This wonderful book fascinated me straight away; I never left it; I read it constantly at table, at the theatre, in the streets, everywhere. This prose version contained some versified fragments, songs, hymns, etc. I yielded to the temptation to set them to music; and this difficult task was hardly finished before I had the idiocy—without having heard a note of my score—to get it printed at my expense." The passage is given as quoted in W. J. Turner's recent biography. Thus originated the *Eight Scenes*

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from *Faust* which were, however, subsequently withdrawn from circulation, but the composer was far from abandoning the subject. It was frequently in his mind and when, seventeen years later, he was travelling in Central Europe, he reverted, to it, incorporating most of the eight original scenes in a much larger work, the dramatic legend or concert opera known as *The Damnation of Faust*. In the Memoirs he writes: "While trailing round Germany in my old postchaise, I composed my *Damnation of Faust*. Each movement is punctuated by memories of the place where it was written. For instance the Peasants' Dance was jotted down by the light of a shop gas-jet one night when I had lost myself in Pesth, and I got up in the middle of the night at Prague to write the song of the angelic choir." Portions were composed at Vienna and on the Danube steamers. He returned to Paris in April, 1846, and arranged to have this work performed. It was given at the Opéra Comique, December 6th, 1846, and repeated on December 20th, both performances being poorly attended.

In the complete work the three excerpts played to-day have their place in reversed order. The *Dance of the Will-o'-the-Wisps* takes place in the third of its four parts, or acts. The scene is before Marguerite's house, where Mephistopheles calls upon the spirits of caprice to enchant and subdue her soul. It is fantastically scored, and based on two themes, to which is added in the *coda* a reference to Mephistopheles' Serenade.

Dance of the Sylphs occurs in the lovely scene on the banks of the Elbe. Faust, rejuvenated, has fallen asleep and Mephistopheles, sending him dreams of Marguerite, summons the sylphs to hover over him with promises of bliss to come. It is scored with the most fascinating delicacy.

The story of the Hungarian March is more involved. In the course of the above-mentioned tour in Central Europe Berlioz arrived at Vienna on November 3rd, 1845, and found many friends there, one of whom—possibly Liszt—lent him a collection of Hungarian national airs. Among them was that of the Rakoczy March, which has a curious history. The original tune was somewhat rudimentary, but in 1809, on the eve of the war which was to bring Napoleon's army to Vienna, John Bihari (1769-1827), a well-known Hungarian violinist-composer of those days, based a march upon it which he played on his violin to Nicholas Scholl, the bandmaster of the "Prince Esterhazy" Regiment. The latter saw its possibilities and orchestrated it. When the regiment marched to Raab to join the main body of the army it was played by the regimental band, and became so popular that Scholl promptly had it published as his own composition. Not only did it retain its popularity, but it became intimately associated with Hungarian aspirations towards national independence. This is the tune that attracted Berlioz so much that during his stay in Vienna, he wrote—according to his Memoirs, in one night—his well-known orchestral version of it.

At that time, in the restless "forties," the atmosphere in Hungary was heavily charged with political electricity. A storm was brewing which was to burst out later. In the circumstances it is not surprising to read in the composer's Memoirs that the first performance of this march in Budapest made a volcanic impression on an audience of patriots. The crescendo which leads to the recapitulation was accompanied by an even more striking crescendo of popular feeling, and the march had to be repeated. The occasion became, in fact, a patriotic demonstration such as few musicians have evoked since Rouget de Lisle wrote the "Marseillaise." The Hungarians asked Berlioz to dedicate the March to them, and he sent them a copy from Breslau, the next stage of his concert tour.

This is the march which Berlioz incorporated in the first part of the *Damnation*. The scene is a plain in Hungary, over which Hungarian troops are marching. As the composer explains in his Memoirs: "The extraordinary effect it produced at Budapest induced me to introduce it in 'Faust' by taking the liberty of placing my hero in Hungary at the beginning of the action." But Goethe's countrymen did not readily condone that "liberty"!

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